

The Life of Malala Yousafzai

Year 6 English | Decodable Reading Passage

Aussie Primary
Academy

Name: _____

Date: _____

Australian Curriculum v9.0 Aligned | AC9E6LY04 | Year 6 | Complex Texts, Perspective & Sustained Argument

LEARNING INTENTION

I am learning to analyse complex texts by examining perspective, evaluating evidence and constructing sustained, well-reasoned arguments.

READING STRATEGY

Identify the author's perspective and purpose. Evaluate the quality of evidence. Consider whose voice is missing. Challenge assumptions and construct your own reasoned position.

READ THE PASSAGE — READ IT 3 TIMES!

On 9 October 2012, a fifteen-year-old Pakistani schoolgirl named **Malala Yousafzai** was shot by a Taliban gunman on her way home from school.

Her crime: **advocating** publicly for girls' right to education in the Swat Valley, where the Taliban had banned girls from attending school.

Malala **survived** the assassination attempt after months of medical treatment in the United Kingdom.

Rather than being **silenced**, she became the world's most powerful voice for children's education rights.

In 2014, at age 17, she became the youngest person ever to receive the **Nobel Peace Prize**.

Her **autobiography**, *I Am Malala*, has been translated into over 40 languages and read by millions worldwide.

"One child, one teacher, one book, one pen can change the world," she declared before the **United Nations**.

Malala's story forces us to examine which children around the world are **denied** the education that many take for **granted**.

VOCABULARY HELPER

advocating = publicly supporting a cause

assassination = the murder of a prominent person for political reasons

Nobel Peace Prize = a prestigious international award for contributions to peace

autobiography = a book written by a person about their own life

denied = refused or not given something

WARM UP — BEFORE YOU READ

Do you take your right to education for granted? What would your life look like without it? Write 2 sentences:

A — COMPREHENSION

1. Why was Malala shot?

2. What did Malala do after recovering?

3. What record did Malala set in 2014?

4. What does Malala's famous quote mean?

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Answer Guide (For Parent / Teacher Use)

Warm Up: Accept personal reflection with 2 sentences.

A1. For publicly advocating girls' right to education. **A2.** Became a global voice for education rights. **A3.** Youngest-ever Nobel Peace Prize recipient. **A4.** Accept: Even one person with access to education and learning can make a huge difference to the world.

B1. Her personal story illustrates the global argument that education is a right, not a privilege. **B2.** 'Forces' = strong verb; implies this is not optional reflection but a moral obligation — the author challenges the reader's complacency.

C: 'One child, one teacher...' — anaphora (repetition of 'one') creates rhythm and emphasises the power of small acts. *Italics* for book titles = standard text convention.

High Five! You are a Super Reader! ✓

Colour a star each time you read the passage aloud:

★

★

★

★

★

EXTENSION ACTIVITY

Research one country where girls' education is restricted. Write a factual report: the situation, its causes, its impact on society and what is being done to change it.

PARENT TIP

Read excerpts from 'I Am Malala' together. Ask: 'What rights do you have that Malala was denied? What would you do if your right to education was taken away?'

TEACHER TIP

Connect to HASS and intercultural understanding. Students compare girls' education access in 3 countries. Create a class advocacy campaign for global education rights.

STUDENT REFLECTION

- ☐ I can explain how an author uses a personal story to make a universal argument
- ☐ I can identify and explain rhetorical techniques including anaphora
- ☐ I can write a sustained argument using a quotation as a starting point